

A

Dear Hugh,

I'm writing you to report the Anna's hummingbird that I saw and photographed at Great Sand Dunes National Monument on 28 July, 1984. The bird was recognized primarily as an Anna's because the gorget color (bright red) matched its crown color. The bird was observed in good light at approximately 7:30 A.M.. There was a feeder very near to where the bird was observed but I never actually saw the bird feed there. I observed the bird for 10 to 20 second intervals for about 10 minutes. The campground was at about 8000 ft. in elevation and is located in a section of pinon-juniper type habitat above the dunes. Also seen there were Broadtailed, Rufous, Black Chinned and Caliope hummingbirds. The photo was shot with ASA 400 film f 5.6; shutter speed=1/250 sec.

I would also like to report seeing Fox sparrows in several places in the front range. Last August I found 3 birds in Jim's grove campground on the Long's Peak trail. This summer I saw one carrying food at Guanella pass on 7 July and 2 were observed by Duane Nelson and myself above the parking lot at the Indian Peaks/Arapahoe pass parking lot.

I mentioned some owls when I talked with you on the phone but the people who were responsible for locating the birds would like to report them themselves. I hope this information is of value to you.

Sincerely,
Wade Leitner

P.S. I'M SORRY ABOUT THIS
BEING LATE - 1 HOUR PICTURE
PERFECT ACTUALLY LOST MY NEGATIVE
WHILE GETTING A SLIDE MADE! IT
HAS BEEN LOCATED & SO I'LL SEND
YOU THIS PHOTO SINCE I'LL BE
ABLE TO GET MORE COPIES.

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒Same as 31-85-36 A

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: ANNA'S HUMMINGBIRD | CALLYPTE ANNA
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): JULY 28, 1984Number of birds seen: ONE Sex: MALE Plumage: _____Locality: PINON FLATS CAMPGROUND, GREAT SAND DUNE NAT'L MON. Elevation: ~8000 ftNearest town: MOSCATE County: SAGUACHETime(s) observed: ~7:30 AM - 7:40 AM (INTERMITTANTLY SEEN)Duration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): ~10 SEC (MAXIMUM)

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

PAT LEITNER - SAME AS ME.

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers)

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

BIRD OBSERVED IN BRIGHT LIGHT - SEEN WELL ILLUMINATED.Optical equipment used (e.g. power, types): GM-1 CAMERA / 80-200 DIETZ ZOOMDistance, and how measured: FROM 100 FT + to 2 ft; DISTANCE ESTIMATEDIf photographed, type of equipment and film: ASA 400 FILM / PRINTS - CAMERA AS ABOVEWho else photographed the bird? _____

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

THE BIRD WOULD APPROACH THE CAMPSITE ACROSS FROM #59 FROM THE WEST. THERE WERE 3-4 RUFOUS HUMMERS CHASING OF BROADTAILS - WHEN THE BIRD APPROACHED IT WOULD LAND IN A JUNIPER NEXT TO A FEEDER AT THE SITE - WAIT, IT SEEMED FOR THE RUFOUS TO BE OCCUPIED & THEN APPROACH THE FEEDER QUICKLY & LEAVE. THE BIRD NEVER ACTUALLY USED THE FEEDER.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observe in the field:

THE BIRD WAS ABOUT THE SIZE OF A RUFOUS HUMMER. IT HAD A BRIGHT RED FOREHEAD & GORGET. THE FOREHEAD COLOR WAS THE SAME AS THE GORGET COLOR. THE BILL SEEMED PROPORTIONATELY SHORTER THAN A BROADTAILS. THE FLANKS APPEARED GREYISH-GREEN. THE GORGET APPEARED SLIGHTLY ELONGATED AT THE SIDES BUT DIDN'T HAVE THE FLAIR OF A COSTA'S. THE BIRD APPEARED GREEN ON THE BACK.

Description (continued):

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

I HEARD ONLY A LOW HUM WHEN IT FLEW.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

PIÑON-JUNIPER FOREST.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

BRIGHT RED-FOREHEAD ELIMINATED THE OTHER HUMMERS (SOME APPEARED SLIGHTLY RED ON THE FOREHEAD BUT THEY LACKED THE BRILLIANCE OF THE ANNA'S) THE GORGET & CROWN WERE NOT PURPLE AS IN ACOSTA'S & THE GORGET DIDN'T APPEAR AS "FLAIRE D'OUT" AS ACOSTA'S DOES.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I HAVE OBSERVED ANNA'S IN ARIZONA & CALIFORNIA & HAVE OFTEN SEEN

ROUFIOUS, BROADTAILED AND BLACKCHINNED HUMMERS. I'VE OBSERVED COSTA'S (♂ & ♀) IN ARIZONA.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: PETERSON GUIDE / AUDUBON MASTER GUIDE / LANE'S BIRDS OF COLORADO.

b) after observation: PHOTO EXAMINED BY CHARLES CHASE.

This report was written from reports made during _____, after observation ☒ from memory ☒
Date and time report was written: _____

Reporting observer: WADE LEITNER

Signature: Wade Leitner

Address: 14079 E. STANFORD CR., AURORA, Colo., 80015

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below:

Return to:

CURATOR, DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGICAL COLLECTIONS
DENVER MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY
CITY PARK
DENVER, CO 80205